For this task we'll use the Spring Framework and Spring Boot to do the following:

- Declare the dependencies needed to implement the application.
- Bootstrap the application with Spring Boot.
- Implement a controller to expose an HTTP endpoint for returning a welcome message.
- Run and try the application.

All the examples in this book are based on Java 17, the latest long-term release of Java at the time of writing. Before moving on, follow the instructions in section A.1 of appendix A to install an OpenJDK 17 distribution. Then ensure you have an IDE with support for Java, Gradle, and Spring. I'll be using IntelliJ IDEA, but feel free to choose another one, such as Visual Studio Code. Finally, create a free account on GitHub if you don't have one yet (https://github.com). You'll use it to store your code and define continuous delivery pipelines.

## *INITIALIZING THE PROJECT*

Throughout the book, we'll build several cloud native applications. I recommend you define a Git repository for each of them and use GitHub to store them. In the next chapter, I'll talk more about managing codebases. For now, go ahead and create a `catalog-service` Git repository.

Next, you can generate the project from Spring Initializr (https://start.spring.io) and store it in the `catalog-service` Git repository you just created. Spring Initializr is a convenient service you can use from a browser or through its REST API to generate JVM-based projects. It's even integrated into popular IDEs such as IntelliJ IDEA and